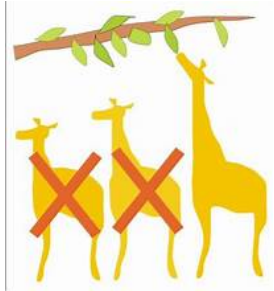
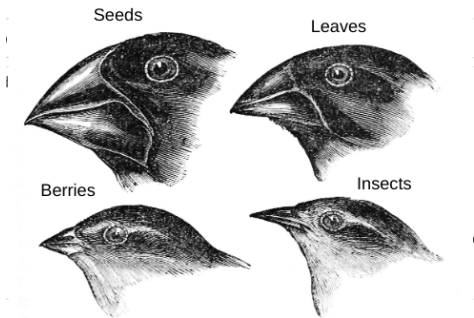


Name _____ HR _____



8th Grade Science Unit 6 Changing Species STAR Cards!

QUESTION	ANSWER
6a)  1) What is a <u>mutation</u> ? 2) How do <u>mutations</u> affect organisms?	6a) 1) A <u>mutation</u> is a mistake in copying an organism's DNA . Mutations change an organism's trait . 2) <u>Mutations</u> are either: harmful, neutral, or will lead to an adaptation .
6b)  1) What is a <u>variation</u> ? 2) What causes <u>variation</u> ?	6b) 1) A <u>variation</u> is a different version of an inherited trait . (Ex. blue eyes vs brown eyes.) 2) <u>Variations</u> are caused by sexual reproduction or mutations
6c)  1. What is an <u>adaptation</u> ? 2. Why are flowers being brightly colored an example of an <u>adaptation</u> ?	6c) 1. An adaptation is a change in an organism's traits that helps it survive and reproduce in its environment 2. Bright colored flowers attract pollinators like bees, allowing flowers to reproduce.

QUESTION	ANSWER
6d) ☆☆☆ What is <u>natural selection</u>?	6d) <u>Natural selection</u> is the idea that organisms that are better adapted to their environment are more likely to survive and reproduce. (This causes species to evolve over time)  The illustration shows three yellow giraffes of different heights reaching for leaves on a tree branch. The two shorter giraffes on the left have large red 'X' marks over them, indicating they are less adapted and less likely to survive. The taller giraffe on the right is reaching the leaves, indicating it is better adapted and more likely to survive and reproduce.
6e) ☆☆☆ 1) What is <u>artificial selection</u>? 2) How is artificial selection beneficial?	6e) 1) <u>Artificial selection</u> is when humans breed organisms with specific mates to create offspring with specific traits. 2) <u>Artificial selection</u> is beneficial to humans because the offspring created have a trait humans want or need. (Ex. seedless bananas, muscular cows for meat)
6f) ☆☆☆ Why do all species on Earth look different?	6f) Organisms have different adaptations that allow them to survive in the different environments they live in. This makes them look different.  The illustration shows four bird heads with different beak shapes, each labeled with its food source: 'Seeds' (a large, thick, conical beak), 'Leaves' (a long, thin, curved beak), 'Berries' (a small, stout, slightly hooked beak), and 'Insects' (a long, thin, straight beak). This demonstrates how different environments and food sources lead to different adaptations.